CHAPTER 6

Encountering the Many "Indias"

In addition to the architectural traces already attributed to the Ghazna Shansabanis and analyzed in Chapter 5, several more survive along the Indus's shores and in its contiguous hinterlands, in what are the western reaches of the Indic sphere. I place five architectural sites within the period of their active presence there, *viz. c.* AH 575–600/1180–1205 CE – years that also witnessed their transformative and enduring successes farther east in the north Indian plains, analyzed in detail in Volume II. As was the case in the foregoing chapters of the present volume, previous scholars' work in the region under examination provides a solid foundation for analysis, and it is supplemented here with my own architectural documentation. Admittedly, the survival of historical data is always partial and random, and it is possible that even among the surviving remains not all have been correctly identified; new "discoveries" still expand the evidentiary corpus (as seen below). By gathering the available data and positing new identifications, plausible observations can be made based on what has managed to reach the moment of analysis. At the very least, I propose overarching characteristics and patterns that serve as points of departure for further study.

The first group, already attributed to the patronage of members of the Shansabani forces, consists of three funerary structures around the economically, politically, and spiritually important city of Multan (ancient Mulasthana) (map, p. xv). A funerary *ribat* near the village of Kabirwala (*c.* AH 576/1180 CE) (Figures 6.16–6.23) lies about 35 km northeast of the city; based on its foundation inscription, it has been identified as commissioned by the Shansabani-affiliated *sipahsalar* 'Ali ibn Karmakh, who was the *wali* of Multan at the time.[1] The structure locally identified as the tomb of Sadan Shahid (Figures 6.24–6.28), located southwest of Multan near Muzaffargarh, had been documented and also dated to the late twelfth century, based on comparative stylistic analysis. In 2011, Abdul Rehman and Talib Hussain published a tomb in the southeastern vicinity of Multan attributed to a certain Ahmad Kabir (Figures 6.29–6.32); the tomb's inscribed (in Arabic) date of AH 600/1203–1204 CE, as well as its overall form and decorative iconography, have both conclusively associated it with the Shansabani presence in the middle Indus region.